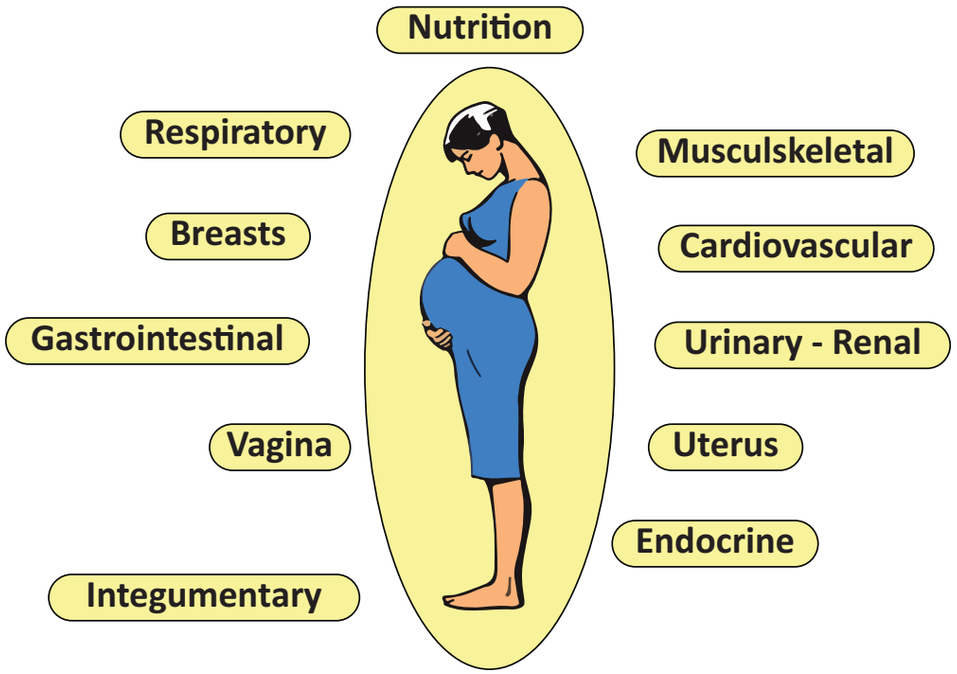
PHYSIOLOGICAL CHANGES IN PREGNANCY



Positive signs

- Fetal heart sounds.
- Fetal movements.
- Fetal parts.

Diagnostic test:

- Blood/urine test for Beta HCG (Human Chorionic Gonadotropin)
- Ultrasonogram

Second Trimester (13-28 Weeks)

- Quickening(feeling of life): The perception of active fetal movement by the woman. Usually felt during 18-20 weeks of pregnancy.
- Progressive enlargement of the lower abdomen by a mass(fetus)
- chloasma-Pigmenation over the forehead and cheek, appear at 24th week.
- Braxton-Hicks contraction: Braxton-Hicks contraction-Irregular, Infrequent, spasmodic painless uterine contraction without any effect on dilation of cervix.
- Ballottment of the uterus.
- Fetal heart sound (FHS) is elicited around 20th weeks by fetoscope with doppler by 16th weeks.

Third Trimester (29-40 Weeks)

Symptoms

- Amenorrhea continues
- Enlargement of the abdomen
- Lightening(fetal head sink in to the pelvic brim)
- Frequency of micturition

Signs

- Skin changes are more prominent
- Uterine shape is changed from cylindrical to spherical
- Fundal height up to the level of ensiform cartilage
- Braxton Hicks contraction
- Fetal movement are easily felt.
- Fetal parts are Palpable.
- Fetal heart rate

Calculation of Expected Date of Delivery

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